



Nanotube transistors

IBM is said to be developing chips with nanotube transistors by 2020 which could be five times faster <http://dgit.in/IBMNanoTrans>



Grant on writing

Robert Grant gives his tips and tricks for writing Sci-Fi <http://dgit.in/rbgrntsfy>

Shalar looked at him pointedly. Kit sighed.

"Relax, old friend. I'm not going to kill her. Not yet, anyway."

With a grunt, Conon's loyal henchman plodded back into *The Prancing Porpoise*.

Kit placed the Foraxian's head onto the dashboard of his bike and pulled out a pipe. He packed the tobacco into it and lit it up, taking a few puffs, the droid seemingly forgotten.

Ka'Dor's eyes lay fixed on this stranger's face. If the species was capable of projecting emotions to a face, this one would show it. As it was, her face was expressionless and cold.

There were several minutes of silence. Neither spoke nor moved, other than Ka'Dor's twitching body and Kit's occasional drag at tobacco.

After a while, the head spoke.

"You spoke of a deal."

Kit made no attempt to respond. Instead, he looked up at the sky.

"Beautiful, aren't they?"

After a pause, Ka'Dor replied, "I wouldn't know. Beauty isn't –"

"– a part of your programming. Yes, I know. Humour me."

Ka'Dor looked up. The *lunes jumelles* lit up the night sky. One a bright luminescent blue, the other a sickly yellow ochre. They cast a greenish tinge across the city scape. The sky, cast in a dark black, lay as a clear canvas for these two rulers of the night devoid of stars.

"From what I know of human taste, they may have an aesthetic beauty. But I don't think they're the reason you ripped my head off."

Kit turned to face her. "I forget. Your kind isn't one for small talk. No. That was

because you decided to make a move for my heart. My apologies, but I've had a very annoying day."

"Self-preservation is in my nature."

"I see. And you thought it necessary to defend yourself because...?"

"You are human." She stated, simply.

Kit stared at her. His face shrouded in shadow, giving away nothing; But it was clear he wanted her to elaborate. Ka'Dor's positronic brain was getting tired of these games.

"If you want to destroy me, please go ahead. There's no point in this delay."

"You haven't been paying attention. I said I wanted to talk," said Kit.

Ka'Dor found this hard to believe, but went with it anyway. "Then talk."

"Have patience. However, if you cannot wait, you may leave." He politely bowed and gestured that she was free to walk away. When she said nothing, he took another puff from his pipe and leaned against his vehicle. After a minute, the droid spoke.

"First of all, I have a name."

"So do I. Except mine's not a serial number. And you're–"

"My name is Ka'Dor."

Kit gave a start. "What?"

"Ka'Dor. It means–"

"I know what it means. *Batarde!* You took on a local name?"

"Why not?" Ka'Dor's head whirred to look up at the twin moons in the sky. "Their aura of mystery is an allure for Foraxians."

Kit stared at her for a few seconds, then shrugged and followed her gaze.

"What do you mean?"

"Well, the stars have been missing for the past decade. Yet, these satellites shine. Two orbs in the sky, illuminating a planet that hasn't seen sunlight in years; An almost divine phenomenon. Yet we know that 'God' does not exist. The logical reason for the existence of the twin orbs has eluded us. Through the years, the Foraxian Empire has come to hold a kind of reverence to them."

She paused.

"But you already knew that."

He repeated the gesture. "It's not exactly common knowledge, but yes, I knew."

"You were attempting to ascertain my claim of being Foraxian."



Concept art by Jason Hazelroth